

Motivation Letter

Oscar Stommendal

Dear Chalmers Erasmus+ Scholarship Committee,

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My name is Oscar Stommendal, and I'm a final-year Engineering Physics student at Chalmers. I'm writing to you due to my enrollment in the interview process for a technical studentship position at CERN. The outcome of this process will be announced in October - November, but I was tipped to apply for the Erasmus+ scholarship now to be eligible if I get the position. Except for the great honor that follows from receiving the scholarship, it would of course significantly ease the financial burden of living in Switzerland.

Since I was very little, I've been driven by a fascination and curiosity about the world around me. Just like CERN, I started asking questions about the universe and how it works. With this traineeship, I want to gain valuable experience from arguably the most prestigious research institution in the world. I believe it will provide me with unique insights and skills that aren't easily attainable elsewhere. From working in a highly international and multidisciplinary environment, to collaborating with some of the brightest minds in physics and engineering, I'm confident that this experience will be transformative for my personal and professional growth. My childhood dream is to become an astronaut, and I believe that a traineeship at CERN will bring me one step closer to that goal, both by providing me with relevant experience and by expanding my network within the scientific community.

As an Engineering Physics student, the connection to CERN is very strong. My program has provided me with a solid foundation in physics, mathematics, and engineering principles, which are all highly relevant to the work being done at CERN. I've also had the opportunity to take courses in particle physics, quantum mechanics, and other advanced topics that are directly applicable to the research being conducted at CERN. Furthermore, my program emphasizes hands-on experience and practical skills, which I believe will be invaluable during my traineeship. I've had experience working in laboratory settings, conducting experiments, and analyzing data – all of which are essential skills for anyone working in a research environment like CERN.

Finally, my reasons for applying for the Erasmus+ scholarship are of course primarily based on the financial aspect. I know that Switzerland is expensive, and as a student without a steady income, it would be a challenge to cover all my expenses. I will receive allowance from CERN as well, however I've learned from experience that scholarships are very worth having, as they can make a big difference in terms of financial stability. Thus, it would decrease some of this financial pressure, allowing me to focus more on my work and learning during the traineeship. Additionally, receiving the Erasmus+ scholarship would be a great honor and recognition of my academic achievements and dedication to my studies. In some way, it would serve as a validation that you believe in my potential and my ability to succeed in this traineeship, which of course also translates to increased confidence in myself. Ultimately, the Erasmus+ scholarship would be a valuable asset in helping me make the most of this incredible opportunity at CERN, and I hope that this letter shows why I'd be a worthy candidate.

Thank you for considering my application. Please reach out if you have any questions or need further information. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Oscar Stommendal